thousands filed since October. All four were written by producers in New York, Atlanta, and London. None of them were the fault of Jerusalem-based correspondents. “I fail to see how the media has something to answer for in terms of systemic bias,” said Luke Baker, the Reuters bureau chief in Jerusalem, who testified at the hearing.

This kind of petty criticism reflects the growing sense that Israel is losing the battle for public opinion in the West. So does the recent proliferation of English-language outlets that take a broadly pro-Israel line. None of them can exactly claim the mantle of journalistic objectivity. There is *Mosaic*, an online magazine published by the Tikvah Fund, the largest financial backer of the Shalem Center, a neoconservative think tank that has groomed several of Netanyahu’s closest associates. *The Tower* is run by The Israel Project, a nonprofit that aims to “communicate proven, effective messages that encourage people to support Israel.” *Fathom* is a project of the Britain Israel Communications and Research Center, a *hasbara* shop in London. It mirrors the prime minister’s efforts to create his own parallel media, and to use social media to get around the “filter” of the mainstream media. “There’s a real sense that Israel is hunkering down,” said one longtime wire service reporter. “Attitudes are changing in Europe and in America, and Israelis are blaming us for that.”

By the end of 2016, Kan was ready to start broadcasting. The corporation had already hired hundreds of journalists and started building a permanent studio. Weeks before the launch, though, Netanyahu suddenly introduced a bill to close it. Finance Minister Moshe Kahlon opposed the move. They eventually agreed on a four-month delay, amending the broadcasting law to bar Kan from launching before May 2017. The IBA would continue operations in the meantime. “The entire goal of the amendment is to buy time,” Netanyahu admitted during a cabinet meeting—time, as everyone knew, that he hoped to use to kill the new broadcaster. The delay will cost Israeli taxpayers 140 million shekels, money that was pulled out of other areas of the budget, like education. Meanwhile, the state finally gave up trying to punish Channel 20, and awarded the right-wing network a license to air news coverage.

In the meanwhile, Netanyahu, emboldened by the rise of Donald Trump, ramped up his hostility to the mainstream press. In November, Channel 2 aired a well-researched documentary on the chaotic and paranoid culture inside the prime minister’s office. The program, based on interviews with